For a rich meat-based stock, use either beef or lamb bones, but never a mixture of the two. If you have any bacon rinds or vegetable trimmings on hand, pop them in the pot too.

brown meat stock

MAKES 2.5 QT (2.5 L) **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 3½–4½ HRS **FREEZE** 3 MONTHS

3lb (1.35kg) raw or cooked beef or lamb bones
2–3 onions, halved
2–3 carrots, halved
a bouquet garni (see p24)
2.5–3 quarts (2.5–3 liters) cold water
1 tsp black peppercorns

1 If you're using raw bones, roast them with the onions and carrots in an oven preheated to 400˚F (200˚C), turning them frequently, for 30 minutes or until browned. If you're using cooked bones, start the stock from step 2.

2 Put all the ingredients into a large pan, bring to a boil, then skim off any foam that rises to the surface with a slotted spoon. Lower the heat, cover with a lid, and simmer for 3–4 hours. Strain the stock through a sieve, pressing the ingredients against the sides of the sieve to extract all the liquid. Cool, then chill in a covered container for up to 3 days. Before use, remove any solidified fat from the surface, then bring the stock to a boil.



hale and hearty
A meaty stock based on beef or lamb makes a world of difference to hearty broth-based soups like French onion soup.